

Visibility Over Perfection:



D O N E
Is Better Than
~~Invisible~~

Title: Visibility Over Perfection: Why Done Is Better Than Invisible

Have you ever been in a situation where someone less qualified than you got the job? Or seen someone join your organisation with fewer qualifications than you would have imagined?

It happens more often than we'd like to admit.

And usually, it's because of one thing: **they took action.**

They showed up, applied, shared their work, raised their hand—without waiting to be perfect.

Because here's the truth: **perfect is an illusion**, and no one will ever know how good your work is, or how skilled you are, if they've never seen you.

So, where are you? Are you visible?

What Does Perfectionism Look Like?

Perfectionism doesn't always announce itself. Sometimes it hides in polite excuses and quiet hesitations that sound noble but actually keep us stuck.

The Many Faces of Perfectionism



The silent

"I don't want to mess up."

The subtle

"It's not my turn yet."



The humble

"I'm not qualified enough."

The quiet

"I can do better."



The fearful

"What will people say?"

The overthinking

"I need a little more time."



But behind each of these phrases lies one powerful truth: **perfectionism can be paralysing.**

It steals opportunities while we're busy polishing, tweaking, and perfecting. While we wait to "add a little more salt" or "one more iteration," someone else - perhaps less experienced, less prepared - shows up visible and ready.

And guess what? The opportunity goes to them.

Because in the real world, **opportunities don't go to the most qualified. They go to the most visible.**

But What Drives the Need to Be Perfect?

Perfectionism is rarely about excellence. It's about fear.

“Perfectionism is the belief that if we do things perfectly and look perfect, we can minimize or avoid the pain of blame, judgment, and shame.” [Brené Brown](#)

So what drives it? Often:

- **Fear of judgment:** “What will people say if I fail?”
- **Fear of not being enough:** The quiet voice that says, “I’m not ready.”
- **Comparison culture:** Constantly measuring yourself against what you see on social media or colleagues’ highlight reels.
- **Imposter syndrome:** Believing your success is luck, not skill - so you overcompensate by trying to be flawless.

Perfectionism becomes a defence mechanism. We build walls of “perfect” to protect ourselves from criticism. But in reality, these walls don’t keep out judgment; they keep out opportunity.

The Trap of Perfectionism

Here’s the catch: Perfectionism feels productive. It feels like you’re preparing, improving, refining. But really, it’s just a well-dressed form of procrastination.

Perfectionism:

- **Stifles creativity.** You edit your ideas before they even have a chance to breathe.
- **Delays progress.** You’re always “almost done” but never ready to ship.
- **Chips away at self-worth.** You start to equate output with value - and when nothing feels good enough, neither do you.
- **Creates invisible professionals.** The ones with the best ideas but no digital footprint, no voice in meetings, no portfolio of shared work.

It's a dangerous cycle: fear of imperfection leads to inaction, which leads to invisibility, which then reinforces the fear that you're not doing enough.

And all the while, the world moves on, rewarding the ones who dared to show up.

So by now, if you already feel like a "perfectionist" or know deep down that you are one. What can you do about it?

How to Overcome Perfectionism

Breaking free from perfectionism isn't about lowering your standards. It doesn't mean sharing work with errors and delivering a half-baked cake.

Rather, it's about redefining success.

Because if something is worth doing 100%, it's also worth doing 20%. Start small, start rough, start now, and iterate later.

Here's how to start showing up without fear:

1. **Redefine what your "done" looks like:**
"Done" isn't perfect - it's visible. Share your work when it's good enough to help someone, not when it's flawless.
2. **Detach self-worth from outcomes.**
Your work is not you. Whether a post flops or a project gets criticized, it doesn't define your worth, it refines your skill.
3. **Use imperfection as feedback fuel.**
Every imperfect post, pitch, or presentation gives you something to learn from. Visibility invites growth.
4. **Start before you're ready.**
Apply for the role you think is out of reach. Share the idea you've been sitting on. Post that unfinished thought.
5. **Celebrate progress, not polish.**
Every step forward is a win - especially the messy ones. Growth rarely looks perfect; it looks like showing up again and again.

Here's a New Standard to live by:

“ I will strive for Visibility Over Perfection

You need to replace “I’ll do it when it’s perfect” with “I’ll start where I am.”

Because being visible isn’t about being flawless - it’s about being present. The world can only reward what it can see.

So the next time you hesitate to post that idea, submit that proposal, or apply for that role because you don’t feel ready - remember this:

Done is better than invisible.

And progress beats perfection every single time.

Have you ever taken action even when things were not perfect? Tell us about that time and how it changed how you view perfection.

Article Caption: Have you ever watched someone land a role you knew you were more qualified for?

It’s not always luck. Sometimes it’s *visibility*.

While many wait for perfect timing, perfect credentials, or the perfect post, others simply *show up*.

This new article dives into why **done is better than invisible**, and how perfectionism quietly keeps so many professionals unseen.

👉 Read, reflect, and tell us about a time you showed up when when things weren't perfect.

Share this to reach someone who needs to show up today.